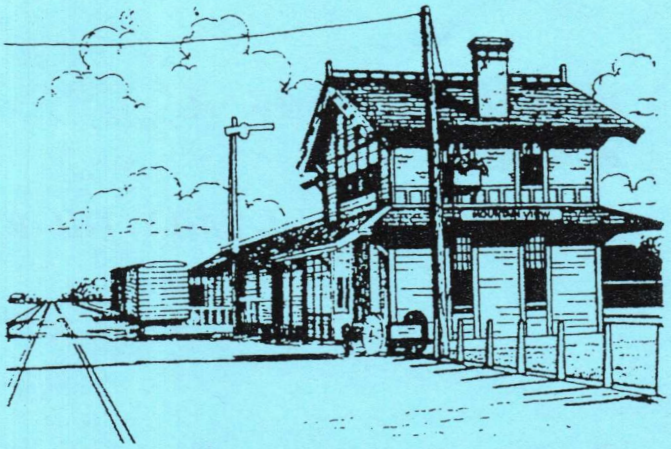
2010

Mountain View Historical Association Newsletter



PRESIDENT'S MESSAGE:

By Honor Spitz

Please note a 1PM start time for this meeting.

PLEASE CHECK YOUR MAILING LABEL TO SEE IF YOUR DUES ARE OVERDUE
(If you are two years in arrears, you will be dropped from our mailing list)

It's a new year already!! Not only that, it's almost a new decade!! So – where did the time go?!! Wasn't it only a few years ago that all of us were worrying about and consumed with the dire predictions about Y2K2?!! Surely you haven't forgotten about that!!

Well, just as quickly as a decade will slip by, so will another and then another after that. While you and I most assuredly will not be around to usher in the next millennium, others will. And while I cannot even begin to imagine what their world will look like, I can say with a fair degree of certainty what some of them will have to look forward to. Bob Weaver and Nick Galiotto continue to work fervently behind the scenes to insure that Mountain View will have a first class museum. Soon we will be forming an Acquisition and Gift Committee with the museum in mind. And, as always, I will continue to "bug" you to jog your memories and contribute a story or two about a favorite Mountain View event in your life.

The coming year promises to bring another star-studded roster of programs for our quarterly meetings. For the up-coming February meeting on Sunday, the 7th, our starting time will be one hour earlier than usual and start at 1PM in order to allow everyone plenty of time to get home and tune in the Super Bowl. How's that for an auspicious start to the new year?!!

FEBRUARY SPEAKER:

By Bob Weaver

THE RENGSTORFF FAMILY, THEIR HOME & "THE FRIENDS OF R HOUSE"

Presented by Charles Grant
February 7, 2010

The Rengstorff House, circa 1867; Mountain View's mansion on the meadow and the City's oldest house, was built from lumber felled from Mr. Rengstorff's 1,200 acres in the highlands of San Mateo County. The house is one of the finer examples of Victorian Italian architecture on the west coast. One characteristic of that style is the widow's walk, a platform on the roof of a house, dating back to Colonial times, so named because many a whaler's wife trod the boards watching to the horizon for a vessel that never returned. How many schooners do you think drove into view of this farm house in Mountain View? Four a week, and they all came to do business with Mr. Rengstorff. More on that later.

Charles Grant, a moving force with the Friends of R House, will be our featured speaker for the February meeting. He has prepared a Power Point presentation for us with dazzling historic images. If you have ever met Charles, you will know he is a dynamic speaker and his enthusiasm for the Friends of R House is contagious.

Come, be entertained and learn more about our sister organization here in Mountain View.

NOTICE: BYLAW AMENDMENTS

Some amendments to the Bylaws will be proposed by the Board at the February meeting for discussion. These changes are to conform with the current nonprofit law and to clarify noticing. Voting will take place at a subsequent meeting of the membership.

MVHA'S INCOME & EXPENSE STATEMENT

Beginning balance as of 8.07.09:	$11,511.64
Income:	1,116.22
Expenses:	(1,653.05)
Ending balance as of 12.15.09:	$10,974.81

MYSTERY SOLVED

Submitted by Barbara Kinchen

At the last meeting, we asked for help with several photos from the Eva Mockbee estate.

Clearly shown was a number of American Legion members, a flag pole and a plaque. It read: For God, Honor, Country. This flag flying today is in honor and memory of Earl Mockbee. Plaque dedicated by United Veterans Council of Santa Clara Co. We wanted to identify the location.

Thanks to a number of people, especially Richard Espinosa, Honor Spitz, Vincent Cortez, and the staff worker on duty that Sunday, we now know the pictures were taken at San Jose's Oak Hill Cemetary.

Richard was so positive about the location that he drove there after the meeting. He reported that on the plaque, in place of Bud's name, the line read "all veterans."

Honor also made a trip to Oak Hill and talked to office personnel. They verified that on flag ceremonies honoring a special veteran's death, that his or her name replaces the "all veterans" line.

Bud Mockbee served in the U.S. Navy during World War II and was active in the local American Legion Post as well as the Mountain View Historical Association. He died in 1993 at age 84.

NEW TO THE LIBRARY'S HISTORY CENTER

Submitted by Barbara Kinchen

From the Lawson family: High School year books, 1949 Centennial program, scale for weighing fruit and bulk items from the Lawson Grocery.

From Eileen O'Halloran: Several 1950-1960s quadrangle maps from the Menlo Park location of the United States Geological Survey.

MEMBERSHIP

Submited by June Casey

Life members:	119
Honored:	2
A/S (single):	104
A/F (family):	74
TOTAL MEMBERS	299

New A/F: Ysidoro and Susan Cortinas.

IN MEMORIUM

JOHN (JOHNNY) VISCOVICH passed away on November 28, 2009 at age 86. He leaves his long-time companion, June Casey, his brother, Charles, and his sister-in-law, Kay. He was preceded in death by his parents, Anton and Filomena, sister, Eva Sisk, and brothers, George and Steven.

John was born and raised on Grant Road and lived there all his life. He attended Mountain View High School and then was a Sgt in the Armed Forces in World War II. After the war, he went into business with his brother, Charles and wife Kay, to operate and own the "T & C," a Los Altos night club. The family also sold cherries and Christmas trees on the family property on Grant Road. John was a member of the Napredak Club, the Native Sons of the Golden West and the Mountain View Historical Association.

I REMEMBER: MEMORIES OF MOUNTAIN VIEW

Submitted by Barbara Kinchen

THE POTATO STORY

A number of years ago, there was a midget in Mountain View – a woman. Today, we call them "little people." She was often seen in downtown as she lived on Dana Street, not far from Castro Street. However, I never did know her name.

One afternoon, in the Lucky market at the Palm Plaza, I saw her in the produce department. She had a shoe in one hand and a potato in the other hand. She would slip the potato into the shoe, reject it, and then she would try another potato. This was rather interesting and I asked her about it. She replied that the shoe was too tight in one or two spots and if she could just find the right size and shape potato, it could be left in the shoe long enough to stretch it.

I laughed a lot as I then went about my shopping, but thought the potato might very well do the job. But, since that time, I have yet to see any one of any size, or gender, or nationality selecting potatoes by shoe size.

Membership: Any person who signifies interest in the aims of this Association and who pays the specified annual dues may become a member of the Association. Aims: The aims of this Association are: to gather and preserve historical data relative to the early settlement and development of the area in and around the present City of Mountain View; to collect, record, edit and publish a history of the pioneering activities of this area; to preserve historic objects and places; to cooperate with other organizations in the Santa Clara Valley on projects deemed worthy by our membership.

MEMBERSHIP APPLICATION / RENEWAL FORM

NAME: _____

ADDRESS: _____

_____

TELEPHONE: _____

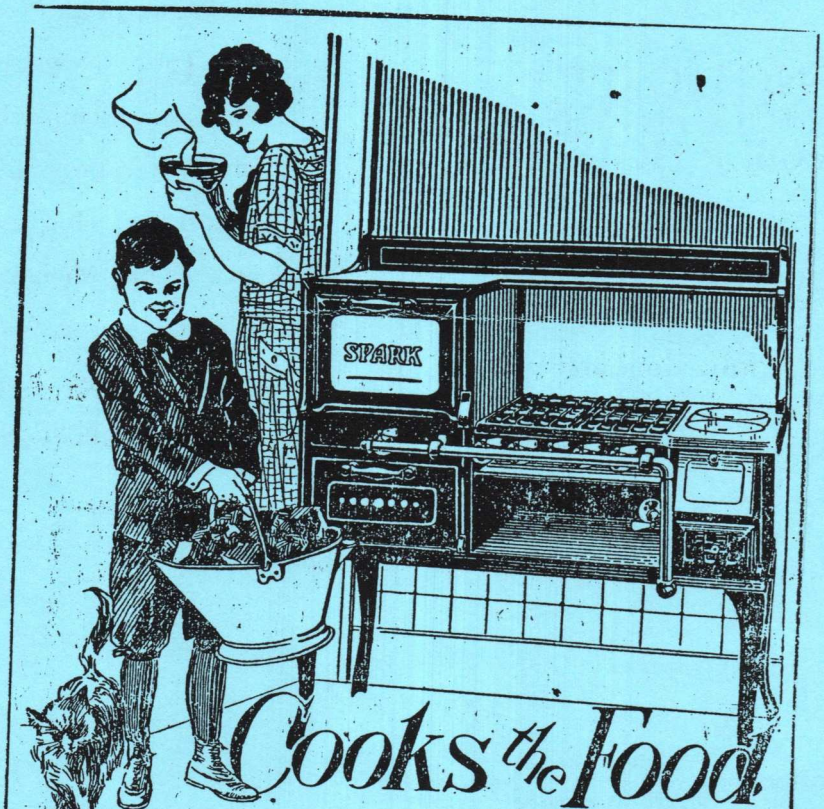
Type (check one): New _____ Renewal _____

Regular Member $10/year

Family Membership $15/year

Life Time Member $200

Please make check payable to:
Mountain View Historical Association
P.O. 252, Mountain View, CA 94042



Cooks the Food
Heats the Home—

$85
Cash

SPARK
THE RANGE BEAUTIFUL

$85
Cash

MARK YOUR CALENDARS!

FEBRUARY 7, 2010

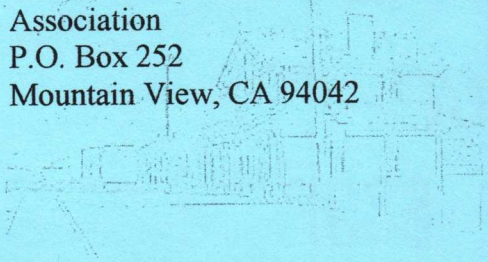
SPECIAL START TIME @ 1 PM

THE RENGSTORFF FAMILY, THEIR HOME & "FRIENDS OF R HOUSE"

Presented by Charles Grant

Held at The Adobe Building
Moffett Blvd. &
Central Expressway

Mountain View Historical
Association
P.O. Box 252
Mountain View, CA 94042



First Class Mail

The Newsletter is published quarterly by the Mountain View Historical Association and is edited by Trudi Tuban. PO Box 252, Mountain View, CA 94042
info@mountainviewhistorical.org
http://mountainviewhistorical.org

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